



INSTRUCTIONAL AREA

Marketing-Information Management

RETAIL MERCHANDISING SERIES EVENT

PARTICIPANT INSTRUCTIONS

(quoted directly from DECA, INC)

- "The event will be presented to you through your reading of the 21st Century Skills, Performance Indicators and Case Study Situation. You will have up to 10 minutes to review this information and prepare your presentation. You may make notes to use during your presentation."
- "You will have up to 10 minutes to make your presentation to the judge (you may have more than one judge)."
- "You will be evaluated on how well you meet the performance indicators of this event."
- "Turn in all of your notes and event materials when you have completed the event."

21st CENTURY SKILLS

- Critical Thinking – Reason effectively and use systems thinking.
- Communication – Communicate clearly.
- Creativity and Innovation – Show evidence of creativity.

PERFORMANCE INDICATORS

1. Describe the need for marketing data.
2. Discuss the nature of sampling plans.
3. Identify data monitored for marketing decision making.
4. Describe data-collection methods.
5. Identify ways to track marketing-communications activities.

EVENT SITUATION

You are to assume the role of the marketing analyst for TECHWORLD, a national electronics retailer that specializes in selling smart home devices, smartphones, computers, and gaming systems. The chief marketing officer (CMO) (judge) wants to introduce a loyalty program to encourage repeat business and increase customer retention, but before moving forward, the CMO needs marketing data to justify the investment.

TECHWORLD has a strong online presence and several hundred physical stores nationwide. While online sales are growing, in-store traffic has been declining. The CMO believes that a loyalty program offering perks such as discounts, early access to sales, and exclusive tech support could help drive both in-store and online purchases. However, there is concern that customers may not find enough value in the program, and the company needs data to understand customer interest, pricing sensitivity, and preferred perks.

The CMO (judge) has tasked you with creating a marketing research plan to gather the necessary data before launching the loyalty program. You will need to:

Propose a sampling plan (who to survey, how many to survey, and how they will be selected)

- Develop specific survey questions to assess interest in the loyalty program and determine which benefits customers value the most
- Recommend data-collection methods (e.g., online surveys, in-store feedback, etc.)
- Suggest strategies to increase response rates and collect meaningful feedback

You will present your marketing research plan to the CMO (judge) in a role-play set in the CMO's office. The CMO (judge) will begin the role-play by greeting you and asking to hear your ideas. After presenting your plan and answering the CMO's (judge's) questions, the CMO (judge) will conclude the role-play by thanking you for your work.

Possible Judge's Questions:

1. Why did you recommend the particular data-collection methods you chose (e.g., online surveys, in-store feedback)?
2. What strategies did you suggest to boost response rates, and how do you think they will help gather meaningful feedback?

Did the participant:		Novice	Developing	Proficient	Exemplary	Judged Score
PERFORMANCE INDICATORS						
1.	Describe the need for marketing data?	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9	10	
2.	Discuss the nature of sampling plans?	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9	10	
3.	Identify data monitored for marketing decision making?	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9	10	
4.	Describe data-collection methods?	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9	10	
5.	Identify ways to track marketing-communications activities?	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9	10	
SOLUTION						
6.	Unique– Demonstrates original thinking, fresh perspectives, and an insightful approach.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
7.	Practical– Actionable/viable in a real-world context.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
8.	Effective– Achieves relevant outcomes.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
CAREER COMPETENCIES						
9.	Critical Thinking– Thinks critically to understand and solve problems.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
10.	Communication– Communicates clearly, effectively, and with reason.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
11.	Decision-making– Considers the impacts of decisions.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
OVERALL IMPRESSION						
12.	Overall impression– The degree to which the presentation leaves a lasting impression.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
TOTAL SCORE						